

# **THE IMPORTANCE OF BREAKTHROUGH IN THE FREEDOM PROCESS**

(Sermon for 7/9/23)

Community Transformation Church is all about the Freedom Process in the lives of individuals, but we do not have a magic wand that we can wave and get people free. The individual must want their Freedom more than we want it for them. Unless this is the case, everything we offer is pretty much useless.

Our Freedom Process includes the following:

- Freedom Weekends...
- The Sozo Process...
- Healing Teams...
- Individual Deliverance if needed...

None of this will work unless the individual is completely honest, sincere, and sold out to being Free.

While all this is important in its own place, the next couple of weeks I want to talk about the importance of Breakthrough in the Freedom Process. Anyone who experiences Freedom will experience Breakthrough at some point in their Freedom Process. Breakthrough happens at different times in the Process, depending on the individual's sincerity, honesty, and willingness to follow the instructions of those who have prepared themselves to lead them through the Freedom Process.

Breakthrough is an interesting term.

Breakthrough is more than incremental advancement. It is that moment in time where everything changes in one critical moment!

Breakthrough means:

- Anointed increase...
- Radical expansion...
- A turning point...
- A turnaround...
- Exceptional maximization...
- Exponential enlargement...

The Psalmist describes breakthrough like this; It is that moment where one could ***“Run through a troop and leap over a wall.”*** It is my prayer that everyone who attends one of the eight Community Transformation Campuses will experience Breakthrough, followed by a life of Freedom.

In considering Breakthrough as a part of the Freedom Process, I want to look at an incident in the life of David.

II Samuel 5:17-25 (NKJV) ***“Now when the Philistines heard that they had anointed David***

*king over Israel, all the Philistines went up to search for David. And David heard of it and went down to the stronghold. 18 The Philistines also went and deployed themselves in the Valley of Rephaim. 19 So David inquired of the Lord, saying, "Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will You deliver them into my hand?" And the Lord said to David, "Go up, for I will doubtless deliver the Philistines into your hand." 20 So David went to Baal Perazim, and David defeated them there; and he said, "The Lord has broken through my enemies before me, like a breakthrough of water." Therefore he called the name of that place Baal Perazim. 21 And they left their images there, and David and his men carried them away. 22 Then the Philistines went up once again and deployed themselves in the Valley of Rephaim. 23 Therefore David inquired of the Lord, and He said, "You shall not go up; circle around behind them, and come upon them in front of the mulberry trees. 24 And it shall be, when*

***you hear the sound of marching in the tops of the mulberry trees, then you shall advance quickly. For then the Lord will go out before you to strike the camp of the Philistines.”***

***25 And David did so, as the Lord commanded him; and he drove back the Philistines from Geba as far as Gezer.”***

News Flash:

All Breakthrough is prefaced by sacrifice. The pattern of sacrifice begins with Abel’s sacrifice and ends with the cries of the saints from beneath the altar in Revelation. None of us will experience Breakthrough, or Freedom, without sacrifice. For us to experience Breakthrough that leads to Freedom we must be willing to ***“Lay aside every weight, and the sin that continually sidetracks us.”*** Not every weight is sin, but every sin adds weight – and the weight that sin adds, prevents Breakthrough, and aborts

the Freedom Process. Unloading the weights and the sin, prepares us for Breakthrough, and eventually our own Freedom.

IN order for David to solidify his hold on Israel he would have to conquer Jerusalem. Jerusalem was not only filled with Jebusites, the Jebusites were full of insults! 2 Samuel 5:6 (LB) ***“David now led his troops to Jerusalem to fight against the Jebusites who lived there. “You’ll never come in here,” they told him. “Even the blind and lame could keep you out!” For they thought they were safe.”*** Have you ever met a Jebusite?

- In your home...
- On your job...
- In your finances...
- With your health...
- Among your children...

Notice, David did not allow the conditions or the insults of the Jebusites to dissuade him!

What are we allowing to dissuade us?

The Bible says the Philistines assembled in the valley of Rephaim. Rephaim means the valley of the giants! Ever had one of those?

If we desire Breakthrough and Freedom, we will probably have to follow David's pattern for victory! Look at what David did to get to Breakthrough, and ultimately, Freedom:

## **I. PRAY...**

2 Samuel 5:19 (NKJV) ***“David inquired of the Lord, saying, “Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will You deliver them into my hand?” And the Lord said to David, “Go up, for I will doubtless deliver the Philistines into your hand.”***

No Breakthrough occurs without prayer! When we are in need of a Breakthrough, we must never assume we know what is in the mind of God. Prayer is necessary to know the mind of God, and to chart a course of victory!

When I mention that we must pray, I am not suggesting that one must pray hours each day, but one must establish a daily appointment to meet with God. We must make it a routine.

When we pray, we must be careful not to do all the talking! We must allow time for listening. Holy Spirit may actually want to respond! He most often responds through God's written Word! So, allow some time for looking into His Word!

Missionary Jim Elliot, who in the 1950's bravely pioneered outreach to the Indians of Ecuador, said, "*The saint who advances on his knees never retreats!*"

Francios (Fran-swah) Fenelon (Fee-Knee-Lone), a 17<sup>th</sup> century French Catholic Archbishop advised: "*Tell God all that is in your heart, as one unloads one's heart to a dear friend:*

- *Tell Him your troubles, that He may comfort you...*
- *Tell Him your joys, that He may sober you...*
- *Tell Him your longings, that He may purify them...*
- *Tell Him your dislikes, that He may help you to conquer them...*
- *Talk to Him of your temptations, that He may shield you from them...*
- *Show Him the wounds of your heart, that He may heal them...*

Before the first battle David prayed and in the second battle he prayed. Never make a major decision without committing time to fasting and prayer.

President Abraham Lincoln said, *“I know that the Lord is always on the side of the right; but it*

*is my constant anxiety and prayer that I and this nation may be on the Lord's side."*

David needed a Breakthrough therefore he could not afford to get it wrong! The only way to make sure we don't get it wrong is to bathe our decisions in prayer.

## TAKEAWAYS:

(Place these on the screen one at a time and leave them up until the end of the service – Have Marisa to make a hard copy for all)

- Decide whether you are going to submit to the Freedom Process... (Sign up for the next Freedom Weekend)
- Establish an appointed time to meet with God every day...
- Make a list of things you are going to begin praying about...
- Choose a reading plan for reading your Bible...

- Ask the Lord to “*Give you ears to hear what the Spirit is saying...*”

**END OF SERMON #1**

# **THE IMPORTANCE OF BREAKTHROUGH IN THE FREEDOM PROCESS**

(Sermon for 7/16/23)

Last week we used King David's experience with the Jebusites as the basis for our study. I would like to continue on that topic today. Last week we learned that as powerful as David was, he found himself in need of Breakthrough.

Breakthrough is a part of every Freedom Process. Breakthrough comes at various intervals, depending on the sincerity and willingness of the individual to be honest, and to follow the prescribed Freedom Process.

As familiar as David was with the Lord, He prayed before facing down the Jebusites, and proceeding with a Freedom Process that involved Breakthrough. Look at what David did

to get to Breakthrough, and ultimately,  
Freedom:

## **I. PRAY...**

## **II. OBEY...**

David was obedient in the first battle and won a great victory. 2 Samuel 5:20-21 (NKJV) ***“So David went to Baal Perazim, and David defeated them there; and he said, “The Lord has broken through my enemies before me, like a breakthrough of water.” Therefore he called the name of that place Baal Perazim. 21 And they left their images there, and David and his men carried them away.”***

Because of David’s Prayer and Obedience, the valley of the giants became the place of Breakthrough! Notice, the victory was so great, ***“the Philistines left their god’s behind!”*** That is what I call Breakthrough!

Though the victory was great, the Philistines were not going to roll over and play dead! Your adversaries are not going to give up easy! Freedom is not a one-time event; it is a Process that can actually take a lifetime – But it must become a lifestyle! Paul said, “***God hath delivered, He doth deliver, and will yet deliver.***”

David’s enemies said, “***Even the blind and lame could keep you out.***” Be assured, your enemy will:

- Mock you...
- Stand in defiance against you...
- Scream into your face, that you should give up...

British Prime Minister Winston Churchill, whose words of courage strengthened his countrymen and led to victory in the face of

ferocious bombing by the Nazis, said, *“You have enemies? Good! That means you’ve stood up for something at some time in your life!”*

Breakthrough and the Freedom Process require Prayer and Obedience – But it also requires Faith! We must learn to see what we can’t see, before we can see it! That is what Faith looks like!

Look at what David did to get to Breakthrough, and ultimately, Freedom:

**I. PRAY...**

**II. OBEY...**

**III. HAVE FAITH...**

It is one thing to Pray and Obey, but it is another thing to have Faith enough to transition when the battle plan changes! 2 Samuel 5:22-24

(NKJV) *“Then the Philistines went up once again and deployed themselves in the Valley of Rephaim. 23 Therefore David inquired of the*

*Lord, and He said, “You shall not go up; circle around behind them, and come upon them in front of the mulberry trees. 24 And it shall be, when you hear the sound of marching in the tops of the mulberry trees, then you shall advance quickly. For then the Lord will go out before you to strike the camp of the Philistines.”*

In the first battle David was told to *"Attack"* but in the second battle he was told to, *"wait"*. I like *"Attack"* better than *"Wait"*! The writer of Hebrews said, *"You have need of patience..."*

Patience in the battle proves one has Faith! Are we walking or running through *“The valley of the shadow of death”*?

Remember, the enemy is not fazed by our previous victories! The enemy will persevere in the face of continuous defeats! The enemy is clinically insane!

If David had followed the strategy of yesterday in the battle of today, he would have missed his divine resources and would not have received his Breakthrough. If we fail to implement a GOD strategy (Pray, Obey & have Faith), we will no doubt miss the Breakthrough!

It will no doubt take Faith to win the battle we face.

Look at what David did to get to Breakthrough, and ultimately, Freedom:

**I. PRAY...**

**II. OBEY...**

**III. HAVE FAITH FAITH...**

**IV. WAGE WAR...**

One thing is an absolute certainly – If one is to have a Breakthrough and own their Freedom, they must be prepared to fight for it! Every day!

Corrie Ten Boom said, *"The first step on the way to victory is to recognize the enemy."*

George Washington said, *"There is nothing so likely to produce peace as to be well prepared to meet the enemy."*

Here is the strategy for the breakthrough against the Philistines:

- Sneak around behind them...
- Position themselves in the mulberry trees...
- When marching occurs in the tops of the trees – wage war...

Have you ever executed a ridiculous strategy to receive a major Breakthrough? Sometimes we must do the ridiculous while expecting the miraculous.

If we want an extraordinary Breakthrough, we must be willing to implement a less than orthodox strategy.

David and his men had to fight the Jebusites –

They beat the brakes off of them the first time around but the next battle had to be waged in a different dimension! When we approach every battle the same way, we rarely see victory, because every incident has a different battle strategy.

Sally Kempton said, *“It is hard to fight an enemy with outposts in your head.”*

David’s Breakthrough was totally dependent on a miraculous action. The word **“marching”** or **“going”** in verse 24 is very interesting indeed. The Aramic version say’s **“The sound of horses hooves.”** The Lord said to David, **“When you hear the sound of horses running through the tops of the trees, attack!”** the last time I checked, horses can’t run through the tops of the trees!

I can almost see the young king telling his men there will be the sound of horse and horsemen in the tops of the mulberry trees!!!

Breakthrough is limited for folks who go out on a limb expecting the miraculous!

The Lord was saying to David, *"you will know by the sound that the God of the Battle, is present to do battle."*

I hear the sound of Breakthrough and Freedom in this house!

The Philistines assumed that David's army was in front of them, so they reasoned that some mighty army was suddenly appearing behind them, to help David's army! So, they fled immediately and were pursued.

I have a word for some folks in this house:  
*"God is about to turn your Rephaim (Valley of Giants) into Baal-Perazim (Breakthrough)."*

## TAKEAWAYS:

(Place these on the screen one at a time and leave them on the screen until the end of the service – Have Marisa to have a hard copy to distribute to all)

- I command every wall that resists my Breakthrough, TO COME DOWN!
- I command every strategy engineered against me, TO FAIL!
- I command every power assigned against my Breakthrough, TO DIE!
- I command every impediment dragging my progress down, TO GO!
- I command every person who has aligned themselves with my enemy, TO FLEE!
- I command every distraction from my destiny, TO TERMINATE!